Students Studying in The United States

GUIDELINES ON MAINTAINING STATUS

While it is your responsibility to maintain your status, the Office of Global Services is here to help guide you through the complexities of the U.S. government regulations and procedures.

MAINTAINING LAWFUL F-1/J-1 STATUS

As an F-1 or J-1 student, you must meet certain obligations in order to maintain lawful nonimmigrant status. Maintaining status is necessary in order to retain eligibility for the benefits of F-1 or J-1 status, such as employment authorization and program extension, and can be crucial to a successful application for a change or adjustment of nonimmigrant

status in the future. Failure to maintain your nonimmigrant status can result in serious problems with immigration and could lead to deportation from the U.S.

F-1 Students: Please also review the information provided by the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) on the Study in the States website (https://studyinthestates.dhs.gov/students/maintaining-status) **regarding maintaining F-1 status.**

Please be sure to click each section and item below and carefully read the information. Contact OGS if you have questions about these requirements.

Consequences of not Maintaining Your Status

If you fail to maintain your F-1/J-1 status, your legal permission to remain in the U.S., utilize the F-1 or J-1 status benefits, such as practical training and employment, as well as your ability to return to the U.S. in the future, may be impacted. This also applies to your accompanying F-2/J-2 dependents' status. If you think you may have violated your visa status, please immediately contact OGS, who will schedule an appointment with you to discuss your situation and your options. The options for regaining F-1 status after a status violation are outlined on the OGS website.

F-1 AND J-1 STUDENT GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

(Click each topic below for more information)

+ Immediately open and carefully read any emails you receive from OGS-donotreply@northeastern.edu (the Office of Global Services email).

+ Attend the School Listed on Page 1 of your Form I-20 (F-1 Students) or DS-2019 (J-1 Students)

+ Submit the Mandatory Immigration Clearance Immediately Upon Arrival in the U.S. at the Start of your Program

+ Report Any U.S. Address, Phone Number, or Name Changes within 10 days of the change

+ Keep Copies of all Immigration-Related Documents (I-20s, DS-2019s, etc.)

+ **Report Changes to Your Immigration Status**

+ **Keep Your Immigration Documents Accurate and Up to Date**

+ **Understand Your "Grace Period" After Program Completion**

F-1 AND J-1 ENROLLMENT REQUIREMENTS

(Click each topic below for more information)

+ **Maintain Full-Time Enrollment and On-Ground Presence During Every Required Term**

+ **Understand Limitations to Enrolling in Online Courses**

+ **Maintain On-Ground Presence in Classes and when Authorized for F-1 Curriculuar Practical Training (CPT)**

+ **Do Not Drop Below Full Time Status Without Prior Authorization**

+ **Request a Leave of Absence in Advance**

+ **Follow Requirements for Study Abroad, Global Co-op, and Research Abroad**

+ **Notify OGS of Any Change in Major, Program, or Degree Level in Advance**

+ **Transferring to Another U.S. School**

+ **Notify OGS if you will Finish or End Your Degree/Program Early**

+ **Notify OGS if you will Finish or End Your Degree/Program Later Than Expected**

+ **Make Normal Academic Progress and Stay in Good Academic Standing**

J-1 STUDENT REQUIREMENTS

Please note that the requirements below are specific to students with J-1 status, who were issued a Form DS-2019. (Click each topic below for more information)

+ **Understand J-1 Student Status**

+ **Maintain Health Insurance Coverage**

+ **Matriculation & Changing Degree Level**

+ **Two-Year Home Residence Requirement (212e)**

+ **12- and 24-Month Bars**

F-1 AND J-1 STUDENT EMPLOYMENT REQUIREMENTS

Employment is a benefit of F-1/J-1 status that has specific requirements and restrictions. You should be aware of these requirements and work only with permission and within the limits of your authorization. Working in the U.S. without appropriate authorization is a serious violation of your status. (Click each topic below for more information)

+ **Limit on-campus employment to 20 hours per week during the academic year.**

+ **Obtain proper work authorization in advance before engaging in ANY off-campus employment (including AT/CPT/OPT/STEM OPT).**

+ **Ensure that any work authorization documents (a CPT I-20, OPT EAD, STEM OPT EAD, etc.) are active and have valid dates any time you are working off-campus.**

+ **Contact OGS before engaging in "volunteer opportunities" or unpaid internships**

F-1 AND J-1 STUDENT TRAVEL REQUIREMENTS

(Click each topic below for more information)

+ **Enter the U.S. No More than 30 Days Before Your Program Starts**

+ **Travel with Required Documents**

+ **Keep Your Passport Valid At Least 6 Months into the Future**

+ **Obtain a Travel Signature for International Travel**

+ **Do Not Enter the U.S. with a Terminated, Completed, Inactive/Deactivated/Invalidated, or Cancelled SEVIS Record**

OTHER REQUIREMENTS

(Click each topic below for more information)

+ **Follow Northeastern University's Code of Student Conduct and All Applicable U.S. Laws and Regulations.**

+ **Maintain Health Insurance Coverage**

RELATED ARTICLES:

Program Extension (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/current-students/understanding-visa-requirements/program-extention/)

Reduced Course Load (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/current-students/understanding-visa-requirements/reduced-course-load/)

Final Term (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/current-students/understanding-visa-requirements/final-term/)

CONTACT OGS

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OGS Service Portal (https://service.northeastern.edu/ogs)

OFFICE HOURS

Monday-Friday: 8:30a.m.-5:00p.m.
(Note: We are closed on Tuesdays from 3:00pm – 4:00pm for all staff training and meeting).

Phone Hours:

Monday-Friday: 8:30a.m.–4:30p.m. ET

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